CALL WALKTHROUGH

Schlüter & Maack Canada

Grain settlement: each producer contract checked against its Elevator Receipts, before anyone settles it

The call	Tuesday 17 November 2026, 12:00 CET, on Zoom (invite sent by our team).
Who we are talking to	Scott Cunningham. He replied to our email himself and copied two colleagues (see Who this is about).
What we are showing	A four-page mock-up that reads a producer contract and the Elevator Receipts delivered against it, checks them, and holds whatever disagrees for a person. All sample data.
What we want from the call	Corrections. The mock-up is our research made concrete. Every guess in it has a question at the end of this document.

The problem in one paragraph

Schlüter & Maack Canada buys mustard from producers on signed purchase contracts and receives it, truck by truck, at its licensed elevator in Balgonie, Saskatchewan. Every load gets an **Elevator Receipt**. Before a producer is settled, somebody has to match each receipt to the right contract and check the weights, the grade and the price, then get the settlement into the system the team uses. Our research says that work is repetitive, deterministic and easy to get wrong. Scott said yes to seeing exactly that:

> *“A tool that reads contracts and Elevator Receipts, checks weights and prices, then sends clean data into the system your team uses.”*

That sentence is ours, from the first email, and he replied “Yes I would be interested in seeing this.” He did not describe the process himself. Everything below the sentence is research.

What we built, in one line

A simulated tool where a settlement set (one contract plus every receipt) must be complete before it runs, is read field by field, and comes out as a worked settlement with the disagreeing lines held for the merchandiser. It never releases a payment, amends a contract or accepts a grade or a price.

WHO THIS IS ABOUT

The company, the people and where the problem lands

The company

Schlüter & Maack buys and handles grain. This demo is about its **Canadian operating entity**, which runs a **licensed primary elevator at Balgonie**, near Regina in Saskatchewan. A primary elevator is where farmers deliver grain by truck. The research found a Hamburg side to the group; we have not looked at it, and it does not show the same process is run there.

The people

Person	What we know	Where it comes from
Scott Cunningham	Spoke on a mustard market outlook panel at the Pulse & Special Crops Convention. Replied to our email, away travelling, back the week of 16 November. His job title is not confirmed.	The email thread
Austin King-Cunningham	Copied by Scott. An Apollo lookup lists him as Merchandising and Logistics Coordinator. Treat the title as unconfirmed.	The email thread, Apollo
C. Rojas	Also copied by Scott. We have no role for this person.	The email thread

Why the problem lands on merchandising and logistics

Our research first put this work in **Accounts Payable**. Scott's reply copied the **merchandising and logistics** coordinator instead, and a February 2026 hiring post for a merchandising and logistics role names producer purchases, contracts, Elevator Receipts, grain settlements and contract price verification. So the demo routes every mismatch to merchandising, and treats Accounts Payable as the people who pay. **This is the first thing to confirm on the call.**

The systems

- **Dynamics NAV**, the merchandise records. Named in the research as where settled values would land. Our own email said only "the system your team uses".
- **Excel** contract and inventory reporting. Also from the research. Nobody has told us what the sheet looks like, so the one in the demo is a guess and is badged as one.

How firm is each thing in the demo?

	What it covers	How it shows in the demo
Sourced	What the email thread says, in our own pitch that Scott said yes to: contracts and Elevator Receipts, checking weights and prices, sending clean data on, a place where the team reviews mismatches.	Stated plainly.
Inferred	What our research says: Balgonie, NAV, Excel, producer, commodity, weight, contract reference, date and price terms, units normalised, and what must stay human.	Stated, but expect correction.
Filled	What we had to invent so the demo holds together: the producer names, every weight and price, a tolerance and a grade discount, the purchase and delivery steps, who gathers a set.	Guess badge on the flow and the contract sheet, plus a question.

Things not to say on the call

That NAV cannot read invoices (it can; this is not an invoice problem). That every settlement is done by hand. That the company has no workflow or document tools. That 80 to 160 settlement sets a month is a known fact: it is our estimate, and so is 20 to 40 minutes a set.

THE WORDS ON SCREEN

A short glossary

The demo uses the words a grain buyer uses. If you have not worked in grain, this page is the difference between a readable demo and an unreadable one.

Word	What it means	Where the word comes from
Producer	The farmer who grows the mustard and sells it to the company.	In the email
Executed purchase contract	The signed agreement to buy a stated quantity of grain at a stated price over a stated period. It has a contract number.	In the email
Elevator Receipt	The paper issued at the elevator for every truckload: who delivered, what, when, the weights and the grade.	In the email
Load	One truckload. A contract usually takes several.	Ours
Gross, tare, dockage, net clean	Gross is the truck weighed with grain. Tare is the truck empty. Dockage is weed seed and dirt taken off. **Net clean = gross, less tare, less dockage.** This is the weight the producer is paid on.	Ours
Grade	The quality class. The price is quoted on No. 1 Canada. A lower grade (No. 2 Canada) is paid less.	Ours
Tolerance	How far either side the delivered quantity may drift from the contract and still be paid at the contract price. The demo uses 5% either way, a placeholder.	Ours (guess)
¢/lb	Cents per pound, how the price is quoted. Receipts are in kilograms, so the tool converts (1 kg = 2.20462 lb).	Ours
Settlement	The sum owed to a producer for the loads on a contract: pounds, times price, less any grade discount.	In the email
Held	A settlement line waiting for a person to decide something. Never paid by the tool.	Ours
Prepared, not released	The stamp on a settlement. Releasing a payment stays with the team.	Ours
NAV	Dynamics NAV, the merchandise records.	Research
Contract report	The Excel contract and inventory reporting, with delivered so far against each contract.	Research
Merchandiser	Whoever buys grain and owns the commercial decisions: amend a contract, agree a price, accept a lower grade.	Ours
Mismatch	A place where the papers disagree. The email's own word: "where your team reviews mismatches".	In the email

WHAT WE BUILT

Each page, in short

Four pages, named in the client's words. The sidebar shows the demo name, the lock button and a permanent sample-data badge.

Settlement Overview

Section	What it is	Why it is there
The top	The producer, contract, grain and delivered total at a glance, with a one-paragraph summary.	So anyone can say what this settlement is in five seconds.
Mismatches to review	The four findings, worst first. Click one to open it.	The reason the tool exists. Nothing is settled while these are open.
Papers in this settlement	The contract, four receipts and the NAV record.	Shows the set was complete.
What stays with your team	Four boundaries: releasing a payment, changing a contract, accepting a lower grade or price, disputes.	The promise that makes the rest safe to show.
The contract, signed against NAV	A grid of the signed contract against the same contract in NAV. The price row differs. Under it, what else was checked and fine, and a tray of every value read, each with the paper it came from.	Catches a wrong price before any load is counted.
Loads against the contract	One row per receipt with a running total against what the contract allows. Flagged rows open their mismatch.	The heart of the check: loads against one limit.
The settlement, worked out	Each load in pounds, priced, line by line. Ready lines and held lines, totals, and the stamp Prepared, not released.	Makes "clean data" concrete: the actual sum.
Open producer contracts, Balgonie	A slice of the Excel contract report: delivered so far against each contract. Guess badge.	So it looks like their sheet. Badged because we invented the shape.

Bring a Settlement In

Section	What it is	Why it is there
Three settlement sets	The main set (5 papers), a clean set (3), and a set with no contract on file (2).	Three different outcomes to show.
The checklist	Every paper the set needs. The check button stays off until all are added. "Add them all" saves clicks on a live call.	The tool never settles from half a set.
The live run	Left: the steps and what has been found so far. Right: the paper being read field by field with the value typed out, then the loads filling in, then the settlement being written. Skip to the result at any time.	Lets the client watch it read their kind of paper.
The result	The main set ends with four mismatches and a button to review them. The clean set ends with the values prepared for NAV. The blocked set ends with a drafted message to the coordinator.	Shows all three endings.

Mismatches to Review

Section	What it is	Why it is there
The two papers	Click a mismatch and the left shows the paper with the exact value highlighted. A tab flips to what the contract says.	Nobody hunts for the other side.
The findings	Four different kinds: a price in NAV, a quantity past the limit, a grade, a weight that does not add up. Each has detail, a suggestion and who it goes to.	Four different failures read as a capable tool.
Edit and confirm	Every mismatch can be edited and confirmed. Confirming passes the flag on with its evidence. It does not pay, amend or accept.	The review step Scott asked for.

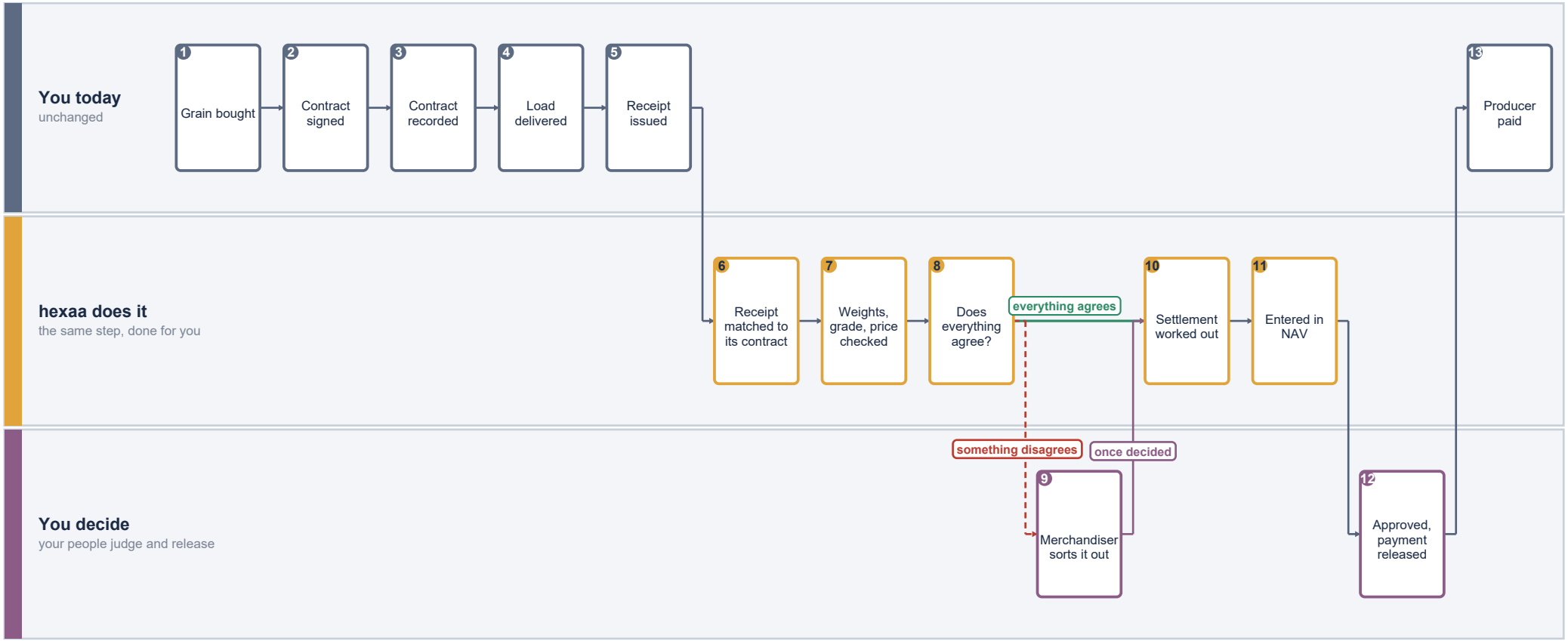
How Settlements Run

Section	What it is	Why it is there
How it runs today	Their process, in flowchart symbols, with no step of ours. Opens here.	Nothing to argue with, so every correction is worth more than agreement.
Where we would help	The same line, coloured by who does each step.	Only who does the step changes.
Questions	The questions for the call. The highlighted group is every guess on screen. Each can be answered or removed.	Whoever runs the call has the list in front of them.
Editing	Click a card to change it, draw a link, add or delete a step or note, export and import.	Done live on the call.

THE PROCESS FLOW, IN DEPTH

The same line, seen by who does each step

In the app the flow is one left-to-right line of flowchart cards. Here it is drawn a second way: three lanes, one for each hand on the work. Read it left to right. The numbers match the table on the next page.



How to read it. The line runs left to right in the order the work happens. Grey is what you do today and keep. Amber is what we would take over: reading, matching, checking, working out the sum and sending the clean values into NAV. Plum is what stays with your people. At step 8 the line forks: **everything agrees** goes straight on to the settlement; **something disagrees** drops to the merchandiser, who decides, and the line rejoins at step 10. Nothing is added to the line and nothing is taken away. Only the hand on the work changes.

THE PROCESS FLOW, IN DEPTH

Their step against ours

Every card on “How it runs today” appears on “Where we would help” in the same place. This table is the check that the two agree. A **guess** mark means the card contains a step we filled in ourselves. Its question is in the list at the end.

#	Their step (how it runs today)	Symbol	Who, in where we would help	What changes
1	A merchandiser buys grain from a producer [guess]	Start / end	**You today**	No change.
2	An executed purchase contract is signed [guess]	Document	**You today**	No change.
3	The contract is recorded [guess]	System step	**You today**	No change.
4	A load is delivered to the Balgonie elevator [guess]	By hand	**You today**	No change.
5	An Elevator Receipt is issued	Document	**You today**	No change.
6	Each receipt is matched to its contract [guess]	By hand	**hexaa does it**	We attach each receipt to its contract as it arrives and compare number, producer, grain and date.
7	Weights, grade and price are checked [guess]	By hand	**hexaa does it**	We work the weights out again, add the loads to a running total, convert units, compare grade and read the price in NAV.
8	Does everything agree?	Decision	**hexaa does it**	We decide what agrees. What does not is written up with both papers and sent to the right person.
9	The merchandiser sorts it out	By hand, below the line	**You decide**	No change. We suggest a next step, you take it.
10	The settlement is worked out [guess]	By hand	**hexaa does it**	We work out the sum: pounds, times the signed price, less any accepted discount. Undecided lines are held.
11	The settlement is entered in NAV	System step	**hexaa does it**	We enter the prepared values as a status record, ready or held. Not a payment.
12	The settlement is approved and the payment released	By hand	**You decide**	No change. Approval and release stay with a person.
13	The producer is paid	Start / end	**You today**	No change.

THE PROCESS FLOW, IN DEPTH

One contract, followed through the line

The demo follows contract **SM-CA-26-0417** with Kozak Prairie Farms Ltd.: 60,000 kg of Yellow Mustard at 47.50 ¢/lb, 5% either way, so 57,000 to 63,000 kg may be delivered. Four loads came in. Here is what happens to them, with the numbers on screen.



Step by step

Step	What happens to contract SM-CA-26-0417	Who and why
1 to 5	A merchandiser buys 60 tonnes. The contract is signed and recorded in NAV and the contract report. Four trucks deliver between 22 September and 29 October, and four Elevator Receipts are issued.	The line is unchanged. These are the steps that already happen.
6	Each receipt is attached to SM-CA-26-0417 and compared on contract number, producer, grain and date. All four pass.	Matching, done for you.
7	**ER-205774**: 31,020 less 14,880 tare is 16,140; less 161 dockage is **15,979 kg**. The receipt prints 16,279. ER-205310 is graded No. 2 Canada, the price is on No. 1 Canada. The loads total 65,130 kg. NAV holds 45.75 ¢/lb, the contract says 47.50.	Checking, done for you. This is where the four mismatches come from.
8	Four mismatches are raised: the price in NAV (critical), the quantity (high), the grade (medium), the weight (low). Each goes to the person who can decide it.	Everything that disagrees is written up with both papers. Nothing is guessed.
9	The merchandiser decides: amend the contract, agree a price for the extra 2,130 kg, accept No. 2 Canada, or call the producer.	A person decides. The tool suggests a next step and never takes it.
10	The settlement is worked out at the signed 47.50 ¢/lb: C$48,923.10 ready, C$18,742.76 held (the No. 2 Canada load and the 2,130 kg above the maximum), C$67,665.86 in all.	The sum, done for you, with the undecided lines held.
11 to 13	The prepared values go into NAV and the contract report as a ready or held record. A person approves, releases the payment and the producer is paid.	Entering is ours. Approving and releasing are never ours.

Why the flow starts at the purchase, not at the receipt

The obvious first card is “a receipt arrives”. That is one or two steps late. A receipt exists because a load was delivered, a load was delivered because a contract was signed, and a contract exists because somebody bought grain. The purchase is the moment the company became liable to pay, so the line starts there. It is a guess (badged), and the first question below.

THE NUMBERS

The four mismatches, and every figure behind them

Every figure in the demo is worked out from the weights, not typed. The four faults below are the only wrong values, planted on purpose.

Mismatch	What is wrong, and what it costs	Goes to
The price in NAV is lower than the signed contract Critical	NAV records SM-CA-26-0417 at 45.75 ¢/lb. The signed contract says 47.50 ¢/lb, 1.75 ¢/lb more. Settled from NAV, the 65,130 kg delivered would come out about C$2,512.77 short for the producer.	Merchandising and Logistics Coordinator
More grain delivered than the contract allows High	The four loads add up to 65,130 kg. The contract is for 60,000 kg, 5% either way, so 63,000 kg at most. Receipt ER-206192 is the load that crosses it: 14,477 kg of it fits, and the last 2,130 kg, worth about C$2,230.60 at the contract price, has no agreed price.	Merchandiser
One load graded below what the price assumes Medium	Receipt ER-205310 is graded No. 2 Canada. The contract price is quoted on No. 1 Canada, and No. 2 Canada is paid 1.50 ¢/lb less. On 16,282 kg that takes about C$538.44 off the load.	Merchandiser
The net clean weight does not add up on one receipt Low	Receipt ER-205774: 31,020 kg gross less 14,880 kg tare is 16,140 kg. Less 161 kg dockage that is 15,979 kg net clean. The receipt prints 16,279 kg, 300 kg higher, about C$313.98 at the contract price. The settlement uses the worked-out weight.	Balgonie elevator office

The loads

Receipt	Delivered	Grade	Gross	Tare	Dockage	Net clean	Running total
ER-204871	22 Sep	No. 1 Canada	31,280	14,820	198 (1.2%)	16,262	16,262
ER-205310	02 Oct	No. 2 Canada	31,540	14,960	298 (1.8%)	16,282	32,544
ER-205774	16 Oct	No. 1 Canada	31,020	14,880	161 (1.0%)	15,979 (prints 16,279)	48,523
ER-206192	29 Oct	No. 1 Canada	31,760	14,900	253 (1.5%)	16,607	65,130
Total							65,130 kg of 63,000 max

Units are kilograms. 1 kg = 2.20462 lb, so a price in cents per pound can be applied to a weight in kilograms.

The settlement

Receipt	Line	Working	Amount	State
ER-204871	Whole load, No. 1 Canada	35,852 lb x 47.50 ¢/lb	C$17,029.70	Ready
ER-205310	Whole load, No. 2 Canada, less the grade discount	35,896 lb x 46.00 ¢/lb	C$16,512.16	Held
ER-205774	Whole load, on the worked-out weight	35,228 lb x 47.50 ¢/lb	C$16,733.30	Ready
ER-206192	First part, up to the contract maximum	31,916 lb x 47.50 ¢/lb	C$15,160.10	Ready
ER-206192	Last part, above the contract maximum	4,696 lb x 47.50 ¢/lb	C$2,230.60	Held
	Ready		C$48,923.10	
	Held for a decision		C$18,742.76	
	Worked out in all		C$67,665.86	

The other two sets: **SM-CA-26-0388** (Brightwater Seed Co., brown mustard, two loads, 31,402 kg against 30,400 to 33,600 allowed) reads clean, C$30,634.28 ready. **SM-CA-26-0452** (Redwood Acres Ltd., two receipts, 31,992 kg) names a contract that is not on file, so nothing is worked out and a message is drafted.

WALKTHROUGH

The order to open things, and what to ask

1	**Open on How Settlements Run, “How it runs today”.** Say: this is your process as we understand it, and nothing on it is ours. Ask them to walk it and shout where it is wrong. Fix cards live. Cards with a guess badge are the ones to ask about first.
2	**Switch to “Where we would help”.** Same line. Point out that only the colour changed. Show the plum cards on the right: those stay with them.
3	**Settlement Overview.** Show the contract against NAV (the price row), then the loads with their running total, then the settlement. Click a flagged row to land on its mismatch.
4	**Bring a Settlement In.** Open the main set and add only two papers: the button stays off. Add the rest and run it. Let them watch a receipt being read. Then run the clean set and the blocked set.
5	**Mismatches to Review.** Open one, flip the tab, edit a sentence, confirm it. Say plainly what confirming does and does not do.
6	**Close on the questions.** Volume, who owns it, who releases, and anything they would not want us near.

Keep it short

Details are in the demo so you do not have to say them. If a card needs a paragraph of explanation, the card is wrong, not the viewer.

QUESTIONS FOR THE CALL

What we need them to confirm

The first group is every guess in the demo: a guess badge on a flow card, or on the contract sheet. These are the ones to ask. A correction is worth more than agreement. The same list is behind the Questions button on the Process Flow page.

1. What we guessed (ask these first)

Every guess badge on the diagrams and on the Overview is listed here.

- ☐ **Does a settlement start with a merchandiser agreeing a purchase with a producer?**
  Why we ask: We started the line there because that is when you become liable for a settlement. Nobody told us it is the trigger.
- ☐ **Does a purchase contract carry a tolerance on the quantity and a discount for a lower grade? What are they on a mustard contract?**
  Why we ask: We used 5 percent either way, and 1.50 cents per pound for No. 2 Canada. Both are placeholders, and the over-delivery and grade checks depend on them.
- ☐ **Is the contract price typed into NAV by hand, or imported from the signed contract?**
  Why we ask: We showed a price in NAV that disagrees with the contract. That only happens if somebody keys it, so please tell us if it is imported instead.
- ☐ **Is each truck weighed in and out on a scale at Balgonie, with gross and tare on the receipt?**
  Why we ask: We drew the Elevator Receipt with gross, tare, dockage and net clean weight. We could not see a real one.
- ☐ **Who grades the load, and does the dockage come off on the receipt?**
  Why we ask: We assumed the grade and the dockage are decided at the elevator, and printed on the receipt.
- ☐ **Who puts a contract and its receipts together, and when: for each load, or once the contract is filled?**
  Why we ask: The whole check starts from a set of one contract and all its receipts. We do not know who builds that set today, or at what moment.
- ☐ **Does anyone check the price in NAV against the signed contract today?**
  Why we ask: We show that as a check. If nobody does it today it is new work rather than the same work done by us.
- ☐ **When part of a settlement is in question, is the rest paid, or does the whole settlement wait?**
  Why we ask: We hold only the lines that disagree and prepare the rest. If the whole set waits, the settlement card changes.
- ☐ **Does your Excel contract report look like the one on the Overview?**
  Why we ask: The research says contract and inventory reporting lives in Excel. The columns and the status words are our invention.

2. The process itself

Whether the sequence on screen is the sequence you actually work in.

- ☐ **Is this the order the work happens in? Which card is in the wrong place?**
- ☐ **Who does this work today: the Merchandising and Logistics Coordinator, or Accounts Payable?**
  Why we ask: Our research put it in Accounts Payable. Your email copied the coordinator, so we routed the mismatches to merchandising.
- ☐ **Who approves the settlement and releases the payment?**
- ☐ **Is a settlement worked out for each load, or once for the whole contract?**
- ☐ **How do the contract and the receipts reach you: email, scan, paper at the elevator?**
- ☐ **What happens today when a receipt names a contract nobody can find?**

3. Volume and cost

We have estimates from research. We would rather have your numbers.

- ☐ **How many settlements go through in a month, and does it change through harvest?**
- ☐ **How long does one take when it goes smoothly, and when it does not?**
- ☐ **What does it cost when a settlement goes out wrong: an overpayment, a correction, a call with the producer?**

4. The checks

Whether these are the right checks.

- ☐ **Are these the right checks? Is there one you would not want flagged?**
- ☐ **What check have we missed that you would expect every time?**
- ☐ **Which grains and contract types do you settle besides mustard?**
- ☐ **Where should the clean values land: NAV, the Excel report, or both?**
- ☐ **Is the process the same at Hamburg, or only at Balgonie?**